Micah Y. Baum

Contact Information

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Research Areas Labor economics, urban economics, economics of education

Education

University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI USA

Ph.D., Public Policy & Economics (expected graduation: May 2027)

M.A., Economics, May 2023

Boston University, Boston, Massachusetts USA

B.A. (*summa cum laude* w/ departmental honors), Economics & Sociology, May 2018

Professional Experience

University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI USA — 2022–2026
Research Assistant
– Brian A. Jacob (2022–2026), Basit Zafar (2024–2025), Sara Heller (2022)
Graduate Student Instructor
– Economics of Education (2024)
– Intermediate Econometrics I (2023)

Literacy Lab (AmeriCorps), Baltimore, MD — 2020–2021
Literacy Tutor

Johns Hopkins University, Baltimore, MD — 2018–2021
Research Assistant

Massachusetts Office of the Treasurer and Receiver General, Boston, MA — 2016
Research Intern, Office of Economic Empowerment

City Year (AmeriCorps), Columbus, OH — 2013–2014
High School Teacher, Tutor, Mentor

Publications

Brockman, S. L., Camo-Biogradlija, J., Ratledge, A., O'Donoghue, R., Baum, M. Y., & Jacob, B. (2025). Forging a path to college persistence: An experimental evaluation of the Detroit Promise Path program. *Educational Evaluation and Policy Analysis*, 01623737241230474.

Baum, M. Y., & Jacob, B. A. (2024). Racial differences in parent response to COVID schooling policies. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 121(3), e2307308120. NBER WP #31765.

<u>*Pre-Doctoral Publications*</u>

Nicholas, L. H., Halpern, S. D., Weir, D. R., Baum, M. Y., Nolan, M., Gallo, J., & Langa, K. M. (2023). Decision Making for Patients With Severe Dementia Versus Normal Cognition Near the End of Life. *Innovation in Aging*, 7(7), igad081.

Baum, M. Y., Gallo, J. J., Nolan, M. T., Langa, K. M., Halpern, S. D., Macis, M., & Nicholas, L. H. (2021). Does it matter who decides? Outcomes of surrogate decision-making for community-dwelling, cognitively impaired older adults near the end of life. *Journal of pain and symptom management*, 62(6), 1126-1134.

Matta, S., Hsu, J. W., Iwashyna, T. J., Baum, M. Y., Langa, K. M., & Nicholas, L. H. (2021). Identifying cohabiting couples in administrative data: evidence from Medicare address data. *Health Services and Outcomes Research Methodology,* 21, 238-247.

Nicholas, L. H., & Baum, M. Y. (2020). Wills, public policy, and financial well-being among surviving spouses. *The Journal of the Economics of Ageing*, 16100211.

Nicholas, L. H., Done, N., & Baum, M. (2020). Lifetime job demands and later life disability. *The Journal of the Economics of Ageing*, 17100184.

Papers in Progress

"When Opportunity Moves to You: Housing Deregulation and the Distribution of Child Outcomes" (Job Market Paper, FSRDC Project #3114).

"Do Faculty Affect Student Partisanship?" (with Joaquín Endara, Annaliese Paulson). *Submitted.*

"Institutional Variation in Child Maltreatment Reporting" (with E. Jason Baron, Joseph J. Doyle, Jr., Maria D. Fitzpatrick, Brian A. Jacob, Joseph Ryan). *Submitted.* NBER WP #35619.

"Peer Socioeconomic Mismatch and Student Achievement" (with Nikhil Rao)

Presentations

2026: NTA *(scheduled)*, APPAM *(scheduled)*, Florida State University *(scheduled)*, Midwest Economics of Education Conference, Upjohn Institute, UEA North American Meeting, University of Michigan, AREUEA, UM-MSU-UWO Labo(u)r Day, AEFP, AEA/ASSA, IRP Summer Research Workshop (poster).

2025: APPAM, NTA, IHS Summer Graduate Conference.

2024: AREUEA, Congressional Budget Office.

2023: AEFP.

Honors and Awards

Best Student Paper Prize, UEA North American Conference 2026 *(Job Market Paper)*

Best Paper Honorable Mention, AREUEA National Conference, 2026 *(Job Market Paper)*

Eckstein Prize for Interdisciplinary Research and Policy Analysis, 2024 *(Job Market Paper)*

Outstanding 3rd Year Paper Award, Michigan Department of Economics, 2024 *(Job Market Paper)*

Highest Distinction, Microeconomics and Macroeconomics PhD Preliminary Exams, 2021

Presidential Scholarship, Boston University, 2014-2018

Funding and Fellowships

National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship (NSF GRFP)

Institute of Education Sciences (IES) Pre-Doctoral Fellowship

Sarri Family Fellowship for Research on Educational Attainment of Children in Low Income Families, Michigan Institute for Social Research (ISR), 2024 - $6,000

Humane Studies Fellowship, Institute for Humane Studies, 2024 - $2,500

Graduate Student Research Grant, Michigan Rackham Graduate School, 2024 and 2025 - $4,500

Graduate Research Grant, Michigan Department of Economics, 2023 and 2024 - $12,000

Professional Service

Referee: *Review of Economics and Statistics, The Economic Journal, Journal of Public Economics, Economics of Education Review*

Applied Social Policy Internship and Research Experience (ASPIRE): Student Mentor (2026)

Causal Inference in Education Research Seminar (CIERS) Coordinator (2025-26)

Michigan PhD Program in Public Policy & Economics: Admissions Committee (2023 and 2026)

Software

Stata, R, Python, Matlab, GIS

Citizenship

United States of America, United Kingdom

Other

Special Sworn Status (US Census Bureau)

References

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and Department of Economics
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